

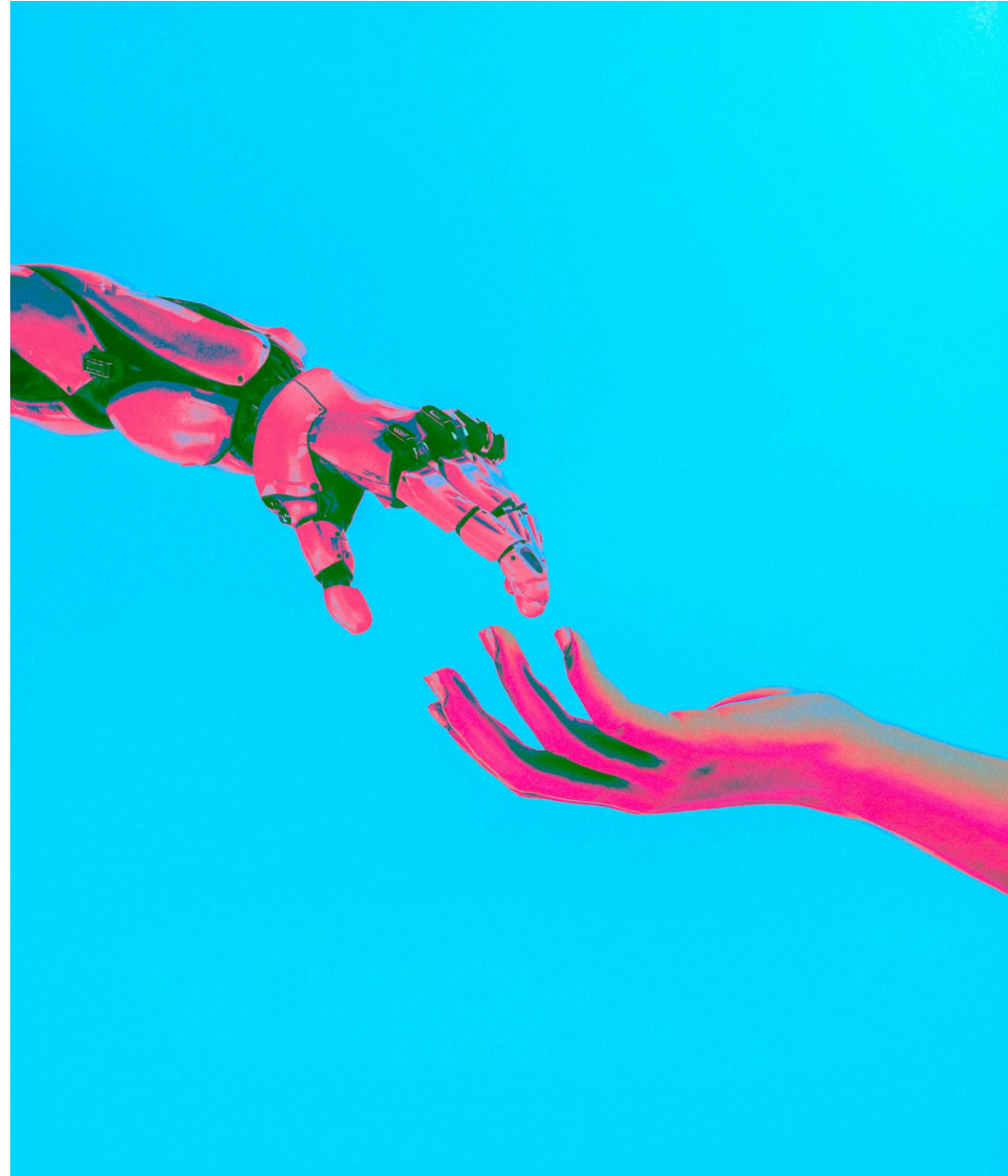
2026 • WINNIE NGUYEN

SESSION 2

Set Up Your **AI** Workflow

A deliberate way to bring AI into the design process.

Winnie Nguyen



ACTIVITY

**One time AI helped.
One time it quietly hurt you.**

— THE NUMBERS

91%

OF DESIGNERS USED AI IN 2026

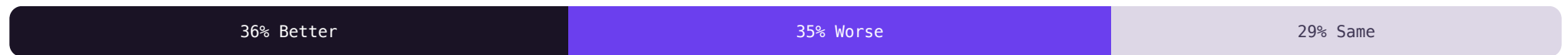
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TOOLS, ON AVERAGE

The question isn't whether you use AI. It's whether you use it deliberately.

— SAME TOOLS, DIFFERENT OUTCOMES

36% said design got better.
35% said worse.



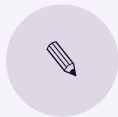
Same tools. Different results. The difference is the workflow behind them.

Figma, State of the Designer 2026

— WHAT'S CHANGING

From **maker** to strategist and editor.

AI is a set of gloves, not a new hand. Stay the strategist.



MAKER



STRATEGIST / EDITOR

MINDSET 1

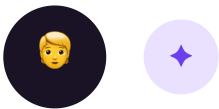
AI takes the tedious work. You keep the judgment.

AI handles what's repetitive. Authorship, taste, and ethics stay with you.

— MINDSET 2

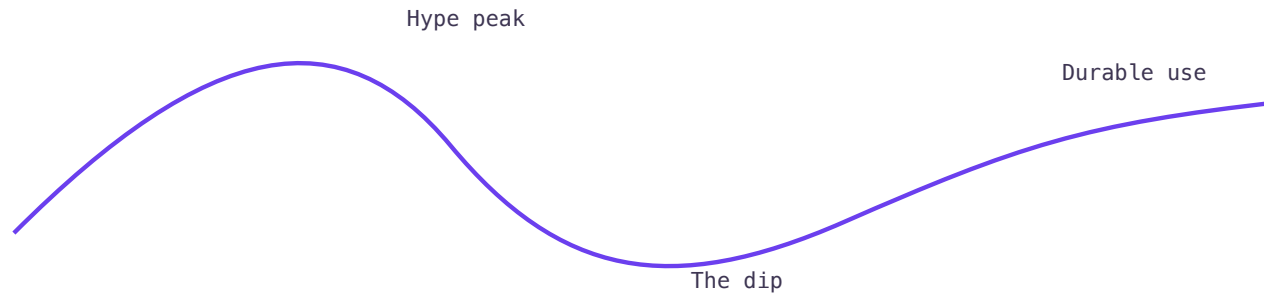
Treat AI like a talented intern. Not an oracle.

Fast, tireless, occasionally brilliant — and it still needs supervision.



Meet Ari.

We've been here before. Remember VR?



Over-promise, then a dip, then durable use. Expect the dip.

ACTIVITY

Share your "helped" and "hurt" moments. What was different?

BEFORE YOU TOUCH A TOOL

**A few words you'll
keep hearing**

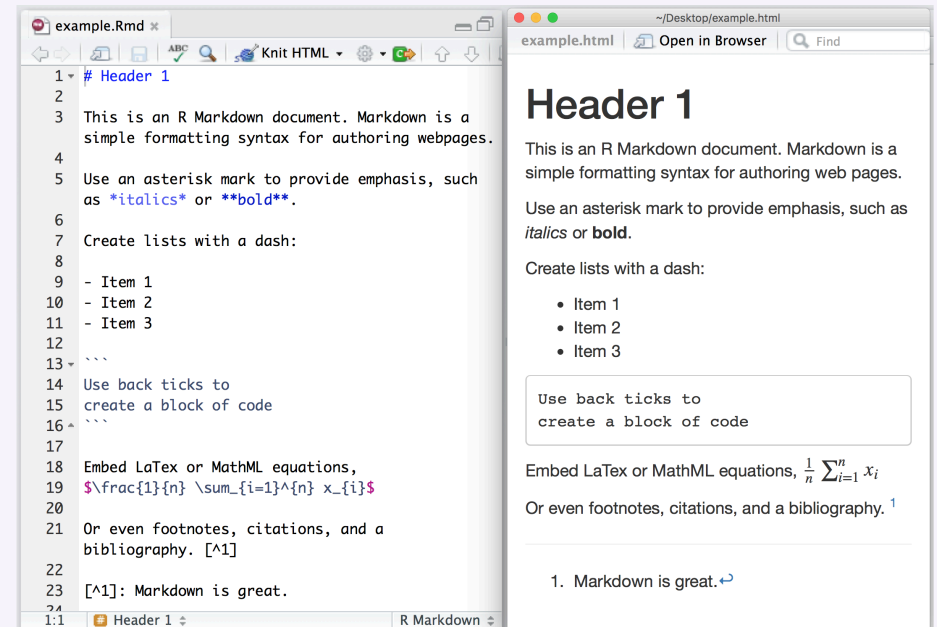
— WORD 1 OF 3

Markdown is just plain text with typing rules.

It's what AI tools read and write by default — structured for AI to parse, light enough to save tokens.

Parses cleanly

Fewer tokens



— WORD 2 OF 3

HTML is what a browser actually draws on screen.

An AI-generated prototype is just an HTML file — a structure a browser can render, not a Figma export.

Real, running code

Click-testable

```
<nav>  
  <button>Home</button>  
</nav>
```

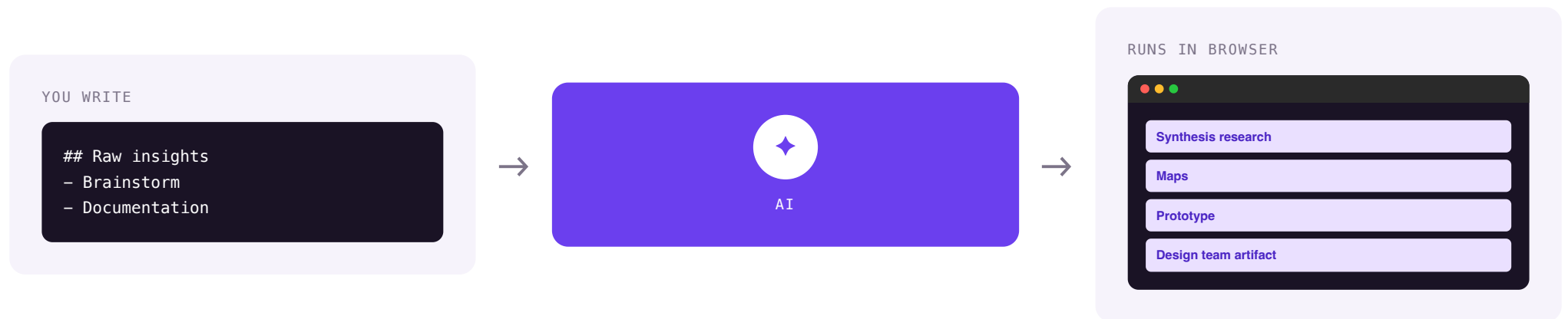
draws as ↓

Home

— HOW THEY WORK TOGETHER

Raw insight in. Formatted report out.

Synthesis themes — Markdown. The report you show stakeholders — HTML.



— WORD 3 OF 3

One project, one folder. Organised your way.

Start on day one, not the day you open an AI coding tool.

01-empathise/

By stage

Mirrors your process.

assets/

By file type

Grab one kind fast.

prototype/

By deliverable

Output over history.

No wrong choice. Only mistake: no structure.

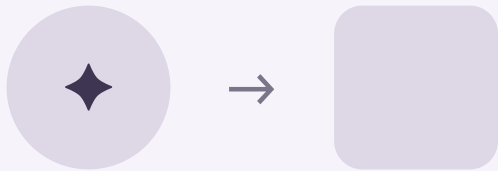
HOW TO ASK WELL

Build your toolkit

— THE THROUGHLINE

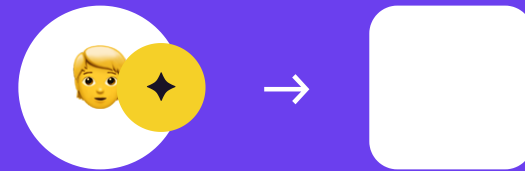
AI-generated: AI decides. AI-assisted: you decide.

AI-GENERATED



AI decides the structure, the words, the layout. You react to what comes out.

AI-ASSISTED



You decide the direction. AI assembles it faster than you could alone.

CARE: Context · Ask · Rules · Examples.

01 **C**

Context

The situation

Who's asking, what project, what stage.

02 **A**

Ask

The specific request

One clear task, not five vague ones.

03 **R**

Rules

Constraints, tone, format

Length, voice, what to avoid.

04 **E**

Examples

Show, don't tell

A sample of what "good" looks like.

— A CONTEXT HABIT

Reuse what you already have. Don't retype it.

A new chat starts at zero. Your folder doesn't.

STARTING FRESH

Long retyped context, every single chat. Slower, and easy to leave things out.

FEED FORWARD

Your folder → straight into the chat. Nothing retyped, nothing lost.

— SEE THE DIFFERENCE

"Make this better" vs. a real brief.

VAGUE

No context. No constraints. No example.

CARE-STRUCTURED

Context, Ask, Rules, Examples — all filled in.

Live demo — same task, both prompts, compare the output.

— WHAT EACH IS FOR

Chat. Coding. In-tool.



AI chat tools

Research, ideation, writing.

ChatGPT · Claude · Gemini



AI coding tools

Pattern into working code.

Claude Code · Cursor · Replit



In-tool AI features

Renaming, detection, suggestions.

Figma AI · Notion AI

Depth beats breadth.

FOUR THINGS YOU DO

Where AI fits in your process

— NOT A NEW FRAMEWORK

Everything you do sorts into four buckets.

Same design process you already know — just named by what you're actually doing.



Synthesising Research

AI HELPS WITH

Interview transcripts

Survey themes

Competitive scans



Setting Up Your Process Map

AI HELPS WITH

Problem framing

Journey maps

Ideation drafts



Prototyping

AI HELPS WITH

Wireframes

Clickable flows

Copy variants



Other Activities

AI HELPS WITH

Test synthesis

Heuristic checks

Stakeholder decks

— NOT EVENLY SPREAD

Strongest at Synthesis + Prototyping. Riskiest at the judgment calls.

The more a task is "decide," the more it stays you.

Synthesising Research

Process Map

Prototyping

Other Activities

What AI does well. What stays yours.

Synthesising Research	AI clusters themes.	You decide which theme is load-bearing.
Process Map	AI drafts a first-pass map.	You handle sequencing and priority.
Prototyping	AI assembles from a pattern.	You handle spacing and hierarchy.
Other Activities	AI drafts fast first drafts.	You decide what's true, what ships.

— THE CHAIN IS THE WORKFLOW

One artifact per bucket. Fed forward, not retyped.

Each artifact becomes your next Context.

SYNTHESISING RESEARCH

 **Research synthesis doc**

PROCESS MAP

 **Journey map / sitemap**

PROTOTYPING

 **Prototype pattern**

OTHER ACTIVITIES

 **Test synthesis / findings doc**

— STILL THE SAME 5 STAGES

This maps onto what you already know.

Synthesising Research

→ Empathise (some Test)

Process Map

→ Define → Ideate

Prototyping

→ Prototype

Other Activities

→ Cross-cutting

ACTIVITY 1

Draft your AI + artifact map

Use your real project. One bucket at a time.

SYNTHESISING RESEARCH

PROCESS MAP

PROTOTYPING

OTHER ACTIVITIES

 **AI in Practice — Paste this prompt into AI tools:**

"I'm a UX designer working on [project]. My users are [who they are]. For each bucket — synthesising research, process mapping, prototyping, other activities — suggest: 1 thing AI can help with, 1 thing that stays my judgment, and 1 artifact I should save to carry forward."

ACTIVITY

Set up your folder. Pick your tool. Run one prompt.

Use your Activity 1 canvas. Use your real project.

Write a CARE prompt — then audit yourself

 **AI in Practice — Paste this prompt into AI tools:**

"I'm a UX designer working on [project], at the [stage] stage. Using CARE, write a prompt for [task]. Then critique it: what's ambiguous, what should I add?"

Did the self-critique catch something you missed? Where does it still leave a decision to AI that should be yours?

ASSIGNMENT 1

Set up your AI workflow

1 Set up your folder

Local folder created and organised, using one of the three options from earlier. Choose your primary AI chat tool as your default for the rest of the program.

2 Brainstorm and set up rules

Brainstorm what you'll ask AI for most often. Start a prompt library — 3+ CARE-structured prompts with your own rules baked in.

If you finished Activity 2 in class, this is mostly about finishing and documenting it properly.

ASSIGNMENT 2

Capture your current screens

- For each key experience, capture the current screen flow as it exists today
- Screenshot each screen — high-level overview, not every micro-state
- Save into your Assignment 1 folder, labelled by state
- We will use these flows next session to set up friction metrics

 **AI in Practice — Paste this prompt into AI tools:**

"Here is my screen flow: [describe or paste]. Draft a one-line label for each screen — what it is and what state it's in."

ONE THING TO CARRY FORWARD

*"The tool will keep changing.
This workflow won't."*

Define clearly. Prompt deliberately. Review critically.

— Winnie Nguyen